

Table 9.9 shows the mean age at marriage for males and females in the urban, rural, and Estate Rural sectors, according to the 2024 Population and Housing Census.

The highest average age at marriage is reported in the urban sector, and this is valid for both males and females. The mean age at marriage is 29.8 years for males and 26.6 years for females. The data further indicate that both males and females in the Estate Rural sector marry at younger ages compared to those in other sectors.

Table 9.10 : Mean Age at Marriage by District of Usual Residence, 2012 and 2024

District	2012		2024	
	Male (years)	Female (years)	Male (years)	Female (years)
Sri Lanka	27.2	23.4	29.2	25.6
Colombo	28.0	24.9	30.1	27.2
Gampaha	27.5	24.3	29.7	26.5
Kalutara	27.2	23.7	29.4	26.0
Kandy	27.8	23.9	29.8	26.1
Matale	27.0	22.5	28.8	24.9
Nuwara Eliya	27.2	23.2	29.2	25.0
Galle	27.3	23.5	29.7	26.0
Matara	27.6	23.5	29.8	26.0
Hambantota	26.9	22.6	29.1	25.4
Jaffna	28.8	26.4	30.8	26.6
Mannar	27.2	24.1	28.5	24.8
Vavuniya	27.6	24.5	29.0	25.5
Mullaitivu	25.8	22.7	28.2	24.5
Kilinochchi	26.3	23.1	28.7	25.2
Batticaloa	26.2	23.0	27.4	23.6
Ampara	26.7	23.0	28.0	24.0
Trincomalee	25.6	22.3	26.8	23.4
Kurunegala	26.9	22.9	29.0	25.3
Puttalam	25.8	22.2	27.8	24.2
Anuradhapura	26.1	21.9	28.0	24.4
Polonnaruwa	25.9	21.8	28.0	24.1
Badulla	27.2	22.7	29.1	25.2
Moneragala	26.4	21.7	28.2	24.2
Ratnapura	27.2	22.9	29.3	25.5
Kegalle	27.5	23.6	29.8	26.0

Table 9.10 shows a comparison of the mean age at marriage for males and females by district of usual residence based on the Censuses of Population and Housing in 2012 and 2024. The mean age at marriage for both males and females has increased in 2024 compared to 2012 in all districts of the country. According to the above table, in 2024 the highest mean age at marriage for males was reported in Jaffna District at 30.8 years, while the highest mean age at marriage for females was reported in Colombo District at 27.2 years. Furthermore, the lowest mean age at marriage for both males and females were reported in Trincomalee District.